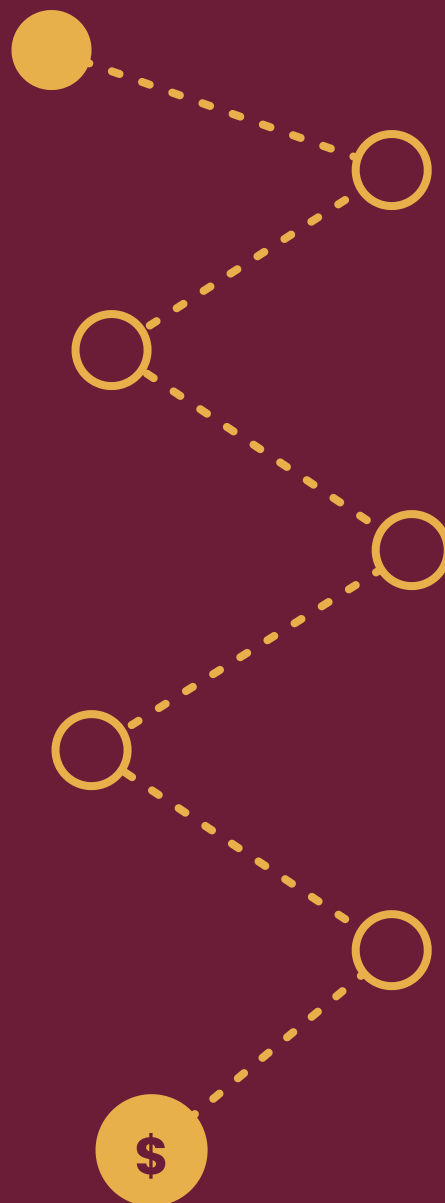


From Idea to *First* Customer

Test it. Offer it. Sell it.

Learn how to validate an idea, create an offer, and find your first paying customer.



Your journey in 7 stops.

Follow them in order. Times are typical, not rules.

- 1 Start With a Real Problem**
 Pick a problem people already want solved. **1 day**
- 2 Talk to Real People**
 Learn from customers before you build anything. **3 to 5 days**
- 3 Shape Your Offer**
 Turn the problem into a clear, simple offer. **1 day**
- 4 Test Demand**
 Check people will pay before you build everything. **3 to 7 days**
- 5 Find Your First Customers**
 Go where your customers already are. **1 to 2 weeks**
- 6 Make the First Sale**
 Have a calm, honest conversation and ask clearly. **1 week**
- 7 Deliver and Learn**
 Turn your first customer into proof and referrals. **Ongoing**

YOUR GOAL

Your first 1 to 3 paying customers.
Not a perfect business.

BY THE END YOU'LL HAVE

- ☐ A clear problem statement
- ☐ Notes from 5+ customer chats
- ☐ A one-sentence offer
- ☐ Test results and real signals
- ☐ A list of 30 prospects
- ☐ Your first sale
- ☐ A testimonial

Start With a Real Problem

Pick a problem people already want solved.

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WHAT TO DO

- 1 List 10 frustrations.** Yours or those of people around you.
- 2 Circle the paid ones.** Which do people already spend time or money on?
- 3 Choose one group.** Pick the people who feel it most.
- 4 Write your problem statement.** Use the template.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

[Who] struggles with [problem] because [reason]. Right now they [workaround], which costs them [time, money or stress].

TIP

Specific beats broad. "New freelancers" is better than "businesses".

× AVOID

- × Picking a problem only you have.
- × Choosing "everyone" as your audience.
- × Falling in love with a solution first.

YOUR TURN

Complete your problem statement.

WHO HAS THE PROBLEM

THE PROBLEM

WHY IT HAPPENS

HOW THEY SOLVE IT TODAY

PAIN SCORE (1 = MILD, 5 = SEVERE)

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

☐ 4

☐ 5

DONE WHEN

You can state the problem and who has it in two sentences.

Talk to Real People

Learn from customers before you build anything.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Find 5 to 10 people.** Choose people who match your group.
- 2 Ask for 15 minutes.** Say it is research, not a pitch.
- 3 Ask open questions.** Then listen more than you talk.
- 4 Write their exact words.** You will reuse them in your offer.

✗ AVOID

- ✗ Pitching your idea.
- ✗ Asking leading questions.
- ✗ Treating "sounds great" as proof.

INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

1. Tell me about the last time you [had this problem].
2. What did you try?
3. What was the hardest part?
4. What did it cost you in time or money?
5. What would a perfect solution look like?

TIP

Ask about the past, not the future. What people did beats what they say they would do.

YOUR TURN

Fill in one row after each conversation.

Person	Problem in their words	What they tried	Interest 1-5
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			

DONE WHEN You have spoken to at least 5 people and see a pattern.

Shape Your Offer

Turn the problem into a clear, simple offer.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Name the result.** What does the customer want to achieve?
- 2 List what they get.** Keep it small and simple.
- 3 Set a price.** Base it on the value of the result.
- 4 Reduce the risk.** A fair refund or satisfaction promise builds trust.

OFFER SENTENCE

I help [who] get [result] in [time] by [method], so they don't have to [pain].

TIP

Sell the result, not the features. People buy outcomes.

✗ AVOID

- ✗ Offering too many options.
- ✗ Pricing with no reasoning.
- ✗ Making vague promises.

YOUR TURN

Build your offer, then say it in one sentence.

WHO IT IS FOR

RESULT THEY GET

TIME TO RESULT

WHAT IS INCLUDED

PRICE

RISK REDUCER (E.G. REFUND)

My offer in one sentence:

DONE WHEN Your offer fits in one sentence a stranger understands.

Test Demand

Check people will pay before you build everything.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Describe your offer.** A short message or one-page summary is enough.
- 2 Show it to 20 to 30 people.** People in your target group, not just friends.
- 3 Ask for a commitment.** A reply, deposit or pre-order.
- 4 Count real responses.** Then decide what to do next.

PRE-SALE MESSAGE

Hi [Name], I'm creating [offer] to help [who] with [result]. I'm opening [3] early spots at [price]. Would you like one?

TIP

A small, honest test beats weeks of guessing.

× AVOID

- × Counting likes as demand.
- × Testing only with polite friends.
- × Waiting for a perfect page.

YOUR TURN

Run at least two tests and record the numbers.

Test	People reached	Responses	Paid or committed
Direct message to my list			
Post in a community			
Simple page or one-pager			

DECISION ☐ Build it ☐ Refine the offer ☐ Try another idea

Suggested signal: at least 3 people pay or firmly commit.

DONE WHEN You have real commitments, not just compliments.

Find Your First Customers

Go where your customers already are.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 List 30 people.** Your network, past colleagues, communities.
- 2 Send 5 to 10 messages a day.** Keep each one personal.
- 3 Help first, then invite a chat.** Give value before you ask.
- 4 Follow up once.** Do it after about 3 days.

✗ AVOID

- ✗ Copy-pasting generic messages.
- ✗ Spamming groups.
- ✗ Asking for the sale in message one.

OUTREACH MESSAGE

Hi [Name], I saw your post about [topic]. I'm helping [who] with [result]. Would you be open to a 10-minute chat? No sales pitch, I'd value your view.

TIP

Most first customers come from direct conversations, not ads.

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YOUR TURN

List 30 people. Start with the first 4.

Name	Where I found them	Message sent	Reply	Next step
1.		☐		
2.		☐		
3.		☐		
4.		☐		

DONE WHEN

You have sent at least 20 personal messages and booked conversations.

Make the First Sale

Have a calm, honest conversation and ask clearly.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 **Listen first.** Repeat their problem back to them.
- 2 **Present your offer.** Use plain words.
- 3 **State the price, then pause.** Stay calm and let them think.
- 4 **Handle concerns.** Then agree a clear next step.

✗ AVOID

- ✗ Talking more than listening.
- ✗ Apologising for your price.
- ✗ Dropping the price straight away.

CLOSING SCRIPT

Let me check I understood: [their problem]. Here's how I can help: [offer]. The price is [price]. Would you like to start?

TIP

If they say no, ask what would make it a yes. Every no teaches you something.

YOUR TURN

Prepare before every conversation.

CONVERSATION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Listened to their problem
- ☐ Repeated it back
- ☐ Explained my offer simply
- ☐ Stated the price, then paused
- ☐ Answered concerns
- ☐ Agreed the next step

OBJECTIONS I EXPECT, AND MY REPLIES

DONE WHEN You have asked at least one person to buy.

Deliver and Learn

Turn your first customer into proof and referrals.

WHAT TO DO

- 1 Welcome them.** Confirm what happens next and when.
- 2 Deliver the result.** Keep your promise and your timeline.
- 3 Check in and fix issues.** Respond quickly if something goes wrong.
- 4 Ask for feedback.** Also ask for a testimonial and a referral.

✗ AVOID

- ✗ Disappearing after payment.
- ✗ Skipping feedback.
- ✗ Forgetting to ask for a testimonial.

TESTIMONIAL REQUEST

*Thanks for working with me!
Could you share one or two sentences about the result you got? You're welcome to edit it freely.*

TIP

Happy customers are your best marketing. Make asking part of the process.

YOUR TURN

Track every customer.

Customer	Result achieved	Feedback	Testimonial	Referral ask
1.			☐	☐
2.			☐	☐
3.			☐	☐
4.			☐	☐

DONE WHEN Your first customer got a result and shared feedback.

Words you can borrow.

Copy, adapt to your voice and use. Always sound like yourself.

FOLLOW-UP (AFTER 3 DAYS)

Hi [Name], just checking you saw my note. No pressure at all. If now isn't a good time, I completely understand.

OBJECTION: "IT'S TOO EXPENSIVE"

I understand. What result would make it worth the price for you?

OBJECTION: "I NEED TO THINK"

Of course. What questions can I answer to help you decide?

OBJECTION: "NOT RIGHT NOW"

No problem. Would it help if I checked back in [two weeks]?

REFERRAL ASK

Is there anyone you know who struggles with [problem]? I'd be glad to help them too.

WELCOME MESSAGE

Welcome! Here's what happens next: [step 1], then [step 2]. You'll hear from me by [date].

REMEMBER

Short, personal and polite wins. Never pressure anyone. A respectful "no" is a good result.

Your first customer in 30 days.

One focus per week. Tick each task as you finish it.

Week 1

- ☐ Write your problem statement ☐ Interview 5 people ☐ Spot the pattern

Week 2

- ☐ Write your offer sentence ☐ Set your price ☐ Run 2 demand tests

Week 3

- ☐ List 30 prospects ☐ Send 5 to 10 messages daily ☐ Book conversations

Week 4

- ☐ Hold sales conversations ☐ Deliver to your first customer ☐ Ask for feedback and a testimonial

MY TARGET

I will have _____ paying customers by _____

Your business on one page.

Fill this in. Keep it where you can see it.

MY CUSTOMER

THEIR PROBLEM

MY OFFER IN ONE SENTENCE

MY PRICE

WHERE I'LL FIND THEM

FIRST 10 PEOPLE I WILL CONTACT

This guide offers general business ideas. It is not legal, tax or financial advice. Results vary, and local rules may apply to selling products or services.